Alikhan Kuatov

Gameplay Programmer

Astana, Kazakhstan | Open to relocation and remote

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Summary

Gameplay programmer with 2.5+ years in Unity, 1.5+ full-time in commercial studios. Shipped World of Drones: FPV Simulator (Android and PC, 1M+ downloads, 4.4 stars): drone controller, enemy targets, upgrade progression and post-launch performance work for low-end Android. Strong on game feel: I tune controls, combat and enemies until they feel right. Five solo games on itch, including the 2D metroidvania Kenotaf.

Experience

Unity Developer, iDos Games | Astana | Apr 2026 - present

- Develop games for iDos Games, a browser games platform: Unity WebGL builds that players launch instantly, with no install.
- Design and build each game end to end as the sole developer: core loop, combat, enemies, UI and progression.
- Short web-first production cycles: fast prototyping, playtesting and tuning, with load size and performance kept in check for the browser.

Unity Developer, OMNIUM | Astana | Mar 2025 - Apr 2026

- Shipped World of Drones: FPV Simulator, an FPV kamikaze drone action game for Android and Windows (published by Take Top Entertainment): **1M+ downloads, 4.4 stars from 4.7K reviews** on Google Play.
- Built the FPV drone controller and camera: speed, turn response and camera effects tuned so high-speed flight stays readable on touch controls.
- Implemented enemy targets and convoys: route movement, defenses that react to the drone, physics-based destruction on impact.
- Built the upgrade progression (battery, durability) and data-driven mission setup on ScriptableObjects, so new levels were configured without code changes.
- Supported the game after launch: bug fixes, a progression rework driven by player reviews, and performance work for low-end Android devices.

Freelance Unity Developer | Remote | Oct 2023 - Mar 2025

- Built a physics-based destruction system for a client action game (title under NDA).
- Optimized gameplay code and rendering for stable performance on low-end mobile devices.
- Implemented gameplay logic and player interaction systems in C#.

Personal projects (solo, design and code)

Kenotaf, 2D metroidvania, Unity, playable in browser (2026) | Trailer

- Interconnected underground city across four distinct zones, with ability-gated backtracking.
- Designed the enemy roster around clear roles: each machine enemy has a readable telegraph, a punish window and a spacing pattern that teaches the player something new.
- Tuned movement and combat feel through playtests: coyote time, jump buffering, hit-stop and knockback.

Symbiont Initiation, action boss-fight prototype, NUGDC Summer Game Jam 2025

- Multi-phase boss fight where each symbiosis grants the player a new ability needed for the next phase.

Skills

- **Engine and code:** Unity, C#, Git, Unity Profiler, mobile performance optimization
- **Gameplay:** combat systems, enemy AI (state machines, behavior trees), physics, character controllers
- **Unity tools:** Animator, Timeline, Cinemachine
- **Design:** combat and enemy design, game feel tuning, playtesting, design documentation
- **Other:** SQL / PL/SQL, PHP, React

Education and languages

BSc in Computer Science, Suleyman Demirel University, 2019 - 2024. Diploma project: ML-based classifier.

Kazakh (native), Russian (native), English (professional working)